



Performance review phrases for communication: 24 examples by rating and situation (2026)

Last checked 5 October 2026. Fill in the [BRACKETS] with your own facts.

Exceeds what the role needs

Explains complicated matters in plain words: for example, [TOPIC AND WHO THEY EXPLAINED IT TO].

Writes emails that need no follow-up questions: for example, [THE EMAIL OR DOCUMENT].

Listens fully before responding and asks good questions: for example, [THE CONVERSATION].

Adjusts how they speak to suit the listener: for example, [THE AUDIENCE].

Meets what the role needs

Writes clearly and to the point: for example, [MESSAGE OR DOCUMENT].

Replies to messages within the usual time: for example, [TYPE OF MESSAGE].

Gives updates in meetings that the team can follow: for example, [MEETING].

Asks questions when something is unclear: for example, [THE QUESTION].

Below what the role needs

Messages are often long or unclear, so readers need to ask follow-up questions: for example, [THE MESSAGE].

Important information did not reach [WHO]: for example, [WHAT AND WHEN].

Says little in meetings, even when they have useful views. I would like to hear more of them: for example, [TOPIC].

Some messages have come across as sharper than intended: for example, [THE MESSAGE AND HOW IT WAS READ].

In writing

Exceeds

Writes updates the reader can act on straight away, with the decision needed in the first line: for example, [UPDATE AND WHO ACTED ON IT].

Meets

Keeps written messages short and checks names, dates and numbers before sending: for example, [MESSAGE OR REPORT].

Below

Messages often leave out the date, the owner or the next step, so the reader has to ask: for example, [MESSAGE AND WHAT WAS MISSING].

Below

Sends long messages with the main point near the end. I would like the point to come first: for example, [MESSAGE].

In meetings

Exceeds

Sums up the decisions and the owners at the end of a meeting and sends the notes the same day: for example, [MEETING].

Meets

Prepares for meetings and speaks to the point when it is their turn: for example, [MEETING].

Below

Often joins meetings without the information they need, which slows the team down: for example, [MEETING AND WHAT WAS MISSING].

Below

Starts speaking before others have finished. I would like each person to finish first: for example, [MEETING].

With customers and other teams

Exceeds

Tells customers about a delay early and plainly, with a new date: for example, [CUSTOMER AND SITUATION].

Meets

Answers requests from other teams within the time they agreed: for example, [REQUEST].

Below

Customers have had to chase for answers on [TOPIC]. I would like replies within [AGREED TIME]: for example, [CASE].

Below

Hands work to other teams without enough notes, so they have to ask what was done: for example, [HANDOVER].

<https://proskillpacks.github.io/managers/performance-review-phrases-communication/>

More free pages: <https://proskillpacks.github.io/managers/>